



Member Boards Connect 2026: Welcome

Emily Banik, MA, PMP, Chair, Self-Assessment and
Lifelong Learning Program Manager, American Board
of Family Medicine

ABMS Member Boards



Thanks to the ABMS Member Boards Connect Advisory Committee

- **Emily Banik**
MA, PMP, Chair, Self-Assessment and Lifelong Learning Program Manager
American Board of Family Medicine
- **Jennifer Hopp**
SPHR, SHRM-CP, CDE, Vice-Chair, Director, Human Resources
American Board of Anesthesiology
- **Eliud Alvarado**
MS, Manager, Test Development Operations
American Board of Internal Medicine
- **Clare Foreman**
Manager, Communications and Stakeholder Engagement
American Board of Preventive Medicine
- **Kristi Jenkins**
Content Editor
American Board of Radiology
- **Meredith Kleiber**
Credentialist
American Board of Internal Medicine
- **Shannon Lamkin**
Senior Resident & Program Coordinator
American Board of Otolaryngology – Head and Neck Surgery
- **Stacie Miller**
CAE, Chief Administrative Officer
American Board of Medical Genetics and Genomics
- **Patrick Murphy**
BS. R.T., (R), (CT), Exam Coordinator
American Board of Medical Genetics and Genomics
- **Brenda Nuncio**
MS, Competency-based Medical Education, Program Coordinator
American Board of Pediatrics
- **Huaping Sun**
PhD, Vice President, Test Development
American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology
- **Marie Teske**
Customer Service Manager
American Board of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation
- **Lyndsay Tyler**
MPH, Director, Strategic Initiatives
American Board of Emergency Medicine
- **Chelsey Williams**
MBA, Chief Operating Officer and Chief Financial Officer
American Board of Allergy and Immunology
- **A.J. Wolf**
Director, Communications
American Board of Emergency Medicine
- **Bonnie Woodworth**
Communications Director
American Board of Pathology

ABMS Staff – Thank you



- Jill Bokalders, Director of Meetings and Events
- Laima Day, Marketing and Communications
- Thom Duncan, Director, Integrated Marketing, Marketing and Communications
- Ilya Samovskiy, Program Manager, Certification Standards and Programs
- Mary Taylor-Blasi, Manager, Programs and Services, Certification Standards and Programs
- And more behind the scenes.

Member Boards Registration Question

- **Key Themes**

- Learning from other Member Boards: Respondents want to understand how other boards operate, including their successes, challenges, standards, and best practices—especially smaller boards or boards facing similar issues.
- Networking and peer connection: Many respondents emphasized the value of meeting and connecting with peers across Member Boards, including staff in similar roles such as assessment editors.
- Innovation, technology, and AI: Several responses highlighted interest in staying current on AI, technology, assessment innovation, IT, policy, and communications practices.
- Operational insight and shared problem-solving: Attendees hope to learn how other boards approach organizational operations, partnerships, professionalism, and common challenges.
- Overall Summary Respondents view attendance as an opportunity to connect with peers, learn from the experiences of other Member Boards, and gather practical ideas to improve their own board operations. Common interests include networking, best practices, AI and technology innovation, communication strategies, policy, assessment, and understanding how boards—particularly smaller boards—address shared challenges.

ABMS MEMBER BOARDS *Connect*

VIRTUAL

March 2 to 3, 2027
11:00 am to 2:00 pm (CT)

Member Board Staff: Save the Date!

Member Boards Connect 2027



Do you want to join the Member Boards Connect Advisory Committee? Email Jill Bokalders at jbokalders@abms.org

MBC Advisory Committee – Roles and Responsibilities

- **Oversee Member Boards Connect logistics**
 - Develop format and content for half-day, in-person meeting in September (includes networking opportunities, breakouts, and plenaries)
 - Develop format and content for two half-day virtual meetings in November (includes breakouts and plenaries)
 - Identify and secure speakers, serve as moderator, etc.
 - Participate in monthly Member Board Staff Advisory Committee planning calls
- **Time commitment**
 - 2-3 hours a month for advisory group members
 - Time will vary based on volunteer opportunities and engagement (we will meet you where you are)
- **Find out how you can get involved for planning in 2027!**
 - Reach out to Jill at jbokalders@abms.org

ABMS MEMBER BOARDS *Connect*

MEMBER BOARDS CONNECT 2026

Agenda at a glance

- 11:00 am ~~Networking Session~~
- 12:30 pm ~~Lunch~~
- 1:45 pm **Plenary Session**
Leading Through Complexity: Building a Change-Ready and Resilient Organization
- 3:15 pm **Breakout Sessions**
- 4:30 pm **Breakout Sessions**
- 5:30 pm **Reception**

Managing Organizational Transformation

Leading through change while protecting mission, people, and performance

Lyndsay M. Tyler, MPH
Director, Strategic Initiatives



**American Board of
Emergency Medicine**

The New Normal Is Permanent Disruption

We are no longer leading through isolated change initiatives. We are leading in an environment of continuous disruption.

- This is not episodic disruption. Research on U.S. organizational leaders entering 2026 describes it as "**a sustained state of flux**"
- There is a difference between managing projects and leading transformation

73%

of organizations are at or beyond "change saturation", which is the point where the volume of change exceeds employee capacity to absorb it



ABEM's Major Change Initiatives

The leadership challenge is cumulative change load, not any single initiative.

 Initial Certification Redesign

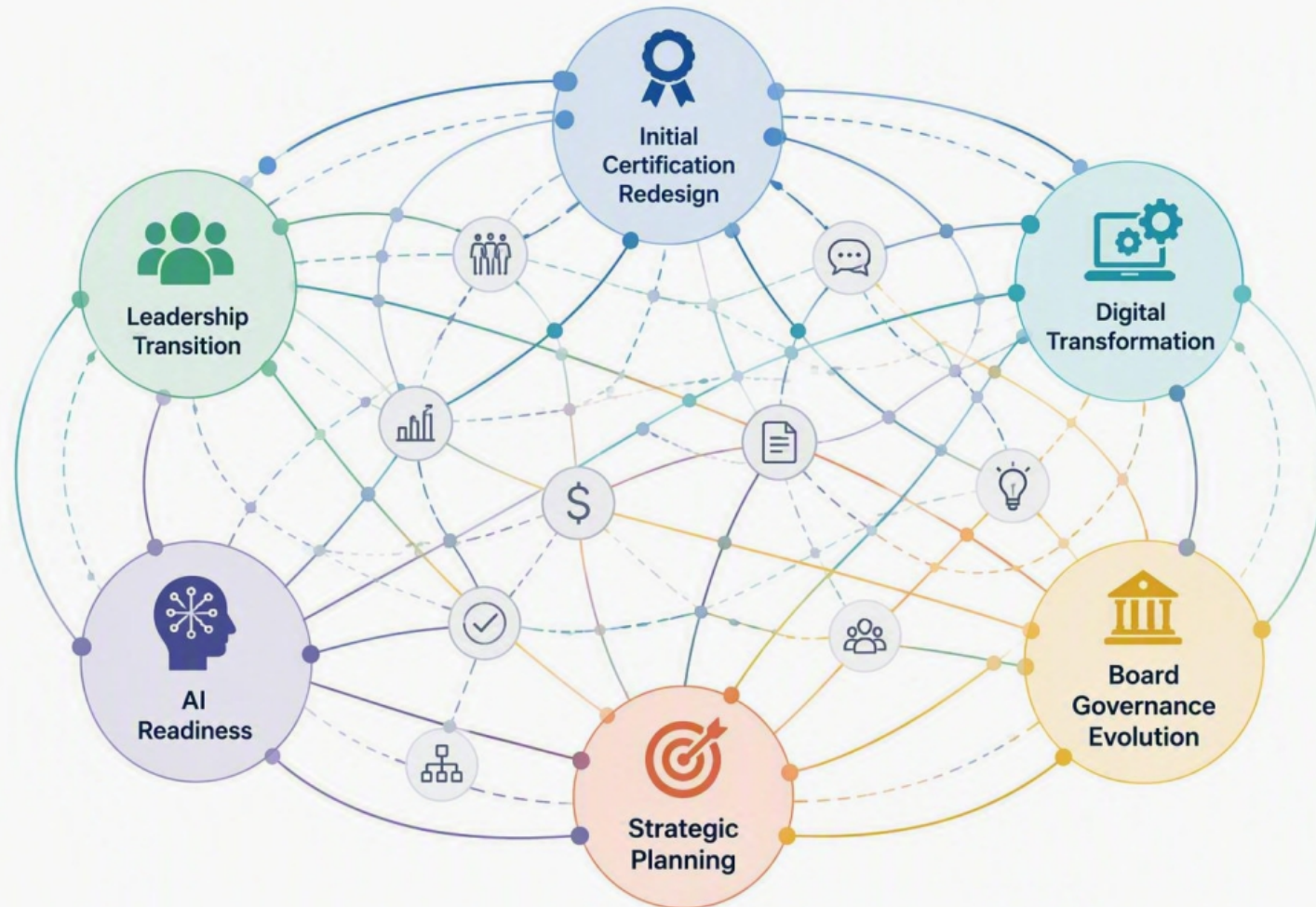
 Leadership Transition

 Digital Transformation

 AI Readiness

 Board Governance Evolution

 Strategic Planning



Create a compelling case for change

1

Pressure

Legacy systems, evolving practice, stakeholder expectations, etc.



2

Meaning

Why standing still creates greater risk



3

Direction

A clear north star tied to mission and public trust

Start with why the status quo is no longer sufficient, not with the proposed solution

Communicate relentlessly

Leaders experience the message dozens of times. Employees may hear it once.

WHY

Why the change matters and why now

WHAT

What will change, and what will remain stable

HOW

How decisions will be made and work will move

WHEN

What happens next and where timing is uncertain

VOICE

How people can ask questions and influence implementation

Say what is known. Say what is not known. Say when people will hear more.

Engage stakeholders early and often

Engagement is not only communication; it is co-creation



ABEM's engagement toolkit

- Surveys and polls
- Focus groups and listening sessions
- Webinars and interactive summits
- Feedback loops during implementation
 - Email updates
 - Staff meeting presentations
 - Debrief meetings
 - Feedback forms

Build a coalition of change champions

Distributed ownership turns a leadership priority into an organizational movement

1

Board

Visible sponsorship

2

Staff

Operational insight

3

Volunteers

Peer credibility

4

Diplomates

Lived experience

5

Partners

Shared influence

6

External experts

Specialized perspective

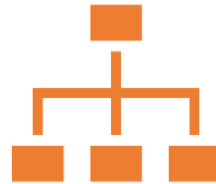
Change cannot be carried by one leader or one department

ABEM Ownership Structure



Sponsor

- Sets strategic direction
- Approves major resources
- Removes roadblocks
- Communicates support to other leaders



Lead/Owner

- Translates strategic direction into execution
- Builds/manages project plan
- Ensures projects meets scope, timeline, and quality expectations



Key Contributors

- Brings subject matter expertise
- Supports execution by completing tasks and deliverables
- Provide guidance and recommendations

Manage change capacity, not just projects

Prioritization is a resilience strategy

- **Change Load:** the cumulative demand of all active initiatives including scope, pace, complexity, and emotional weight of uncertainty
- **Change Capacity:** the finite human, operational, and cognitive resources available to absorb change



Warning Signs: cynicism about new initiatives, slower adoption, increased errors, prioritization paralysis, emotional withdrawal

THE EISENHOWER MATRIX



A simple framework to help you prioritize tasks by urgency and importance

Focus on what matters most.



KEY INSIGHT: The highest value comes from spending more time in Quadrant 2 (Important, Not Urgent) — working on what matters most to achieve your long-term goals.



American College of
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Create Staff Capacity

Protecting staff capacity requires actively removing work, not just managing it

Stop-Doing Lists

- Ask: "What work can we eliminate, reduce, or hand off entirely?"
- Review recurring tasks, standing meetings, and approval chains; eliminate those that no longer serve mission
- Use the Eisenhower Matrix as a guide: if it is neither urgent nor important, stop it
- Set a team norm: each quarter, identify at least one thing to stop before adding something new

Use AI for Lower-Order Tasks

Lower-order: repetitive, rule-based, templated tasks are candidates for automation or elimination

Higher-order: judgment, relationship, creativity, complexity is the work only people can do

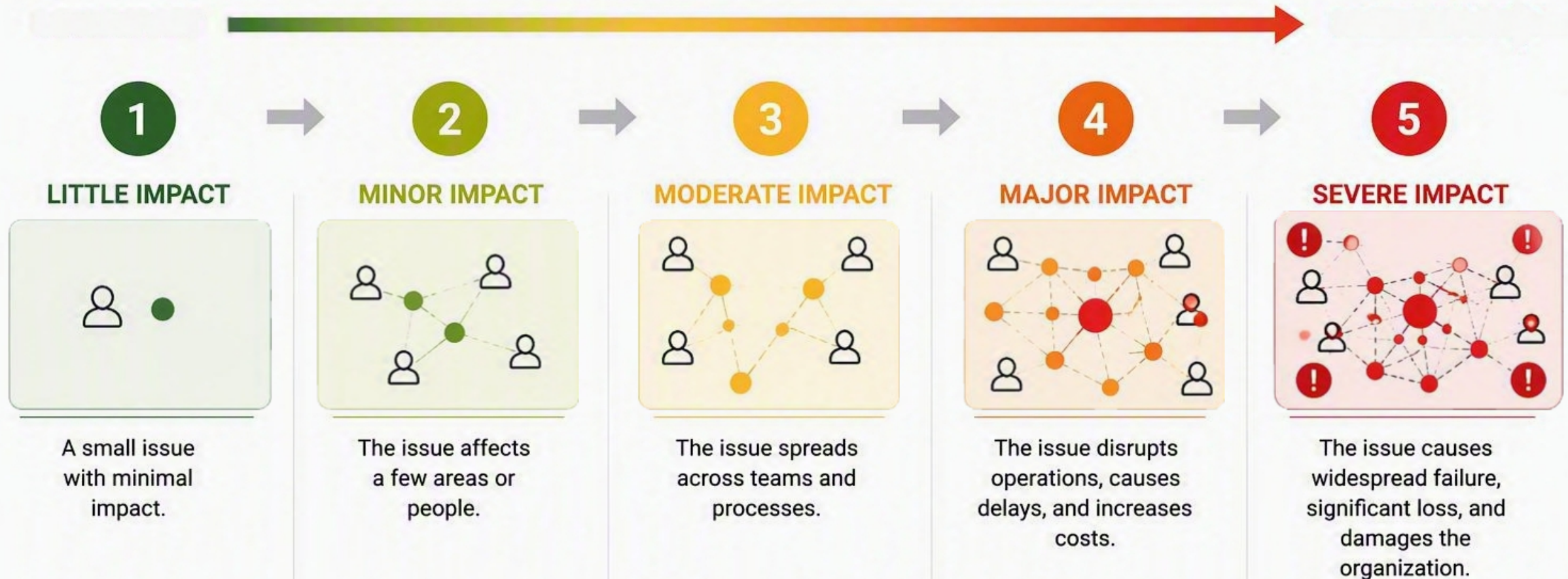
- Practical AI applications: drafting routine communications, summarizing documents, generating first-draft reports, scheduling coordination, and data entry



Shift the ratio: more time on mission-critical, human-centered work and less time on lower-order tasks. This is an investment in people, not a cost-cutting exercise.

SCALING PROBLEMS: FROM SMALL TO SEVERE

Small issues ignored today can become major problems tomorrow.



Support people through the transitions

Organizational change is structural. Human transition is personal.

1

HONOR

Recognize the legacy and contributions of long-serving team members and create room for new approaches without discarding what already works

2

CELEBRATE

Celebrate milestones along the way, not just the destination

3

CONNECT

Connect daily work to the mission

4

VOICE

Give staff genuine input, not performative consultation

People need stability, connection, meaning, and voice.

Resilience is a system, not a personality trait

The goal is not to avoid disruption. It is to absorb change without losing mission, trust, or people.

ANTICIPATE

Scan for emerging risk and opportunity

ADAPT

Shift priorities, roles, and resources

RECOVER

Restore capacity after high-demand periods

LEARN

Convert experience into better systems



Five Takeaways

1

CREATE CLARITY

Help people understand the why.

2

BUILD ALIGNMENT

Focus effort on the few priorities that matter most.

3

SUSTAIN ENGAGEMENT

Involve people in shaping and improving the change.

4

PROTECT CAPACITY

Sequence work and reduce cumulative change load.

5

STRENGTHEN RESILIENCE

Build systems that can anticipate, adapt, recover, and learn.



**American Board of
Emergency Medicine**

CONTACT

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RESOURCES

1. Prosci. Change saturation: what it is and how to deal with it. Prosci website. Accessed September 11, 2026. <https://www.prosci.com/change-saturation>
2. Covey SR. The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People. Free Press; 1989. (Eisenhower Matrix/prioritization framework)

Building a Change-Ready and Resilient Organization

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Heather Honeycutt, MBA, MPM, Vice President, Organizational Effectiveness

Five principles, multiple tactics

- 1 Change is about head **and** heart.
- 2 Engage staff **along the way**.
- 3 Close the **loop**.
- 4 Give them the **words**, then empower them to use them.
- 5 Creatively communicate the **why**.



1

PRINCIPLE

Head & Heart



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Readiness & change management



THE HEART how people felt

POSITIVE

Excitement
Curious
Optimism
Hopeful
Finally

NEGATIVE

Uncertainty
Trepidation
Overwhelming
Long
Painful



THE HEAD what people thought

OPPORTUNITY

Streamline
Innovation
Transparency
Debugging
Efficiency

RISK

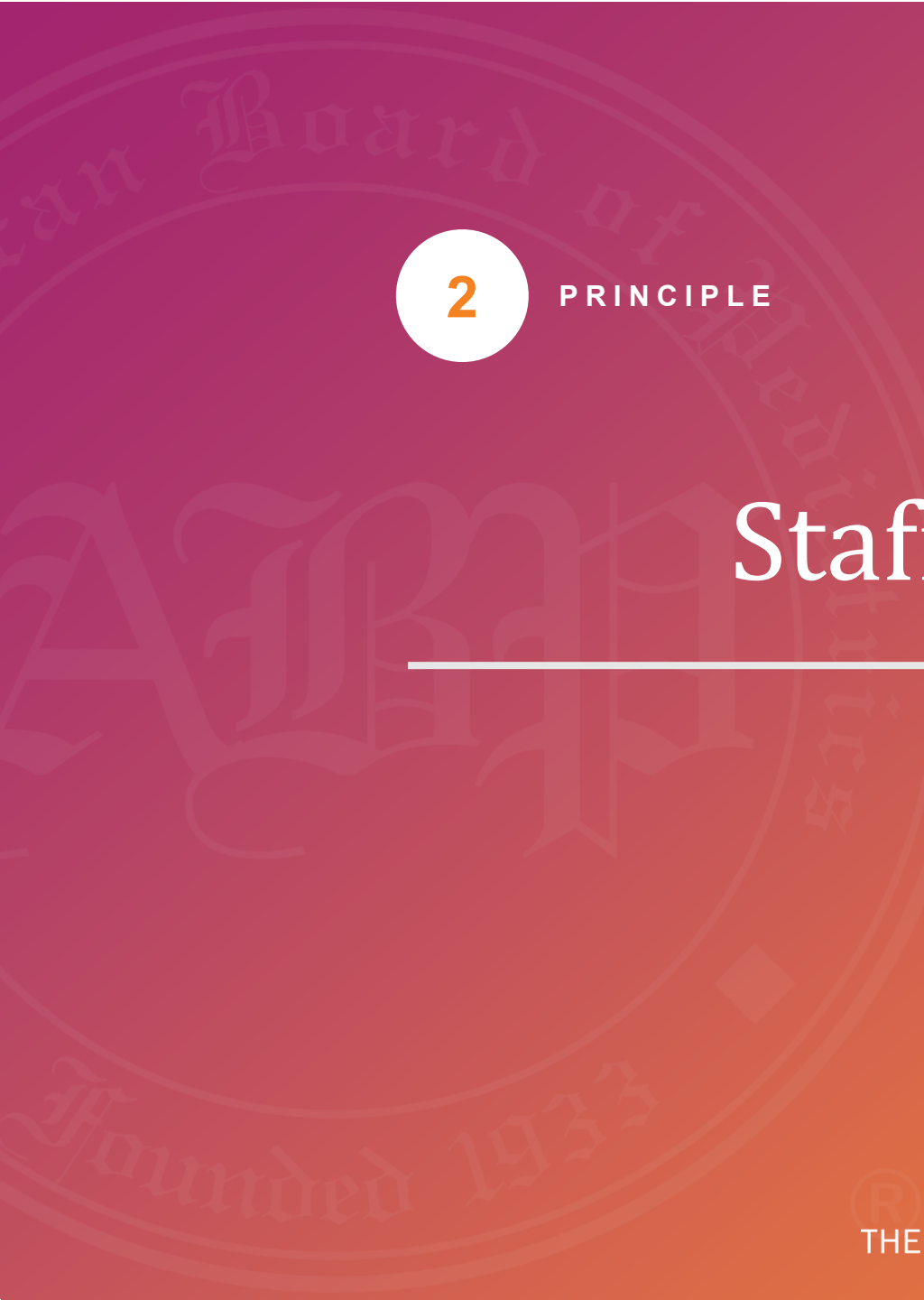
Data security
Inflexibility
Cost
Capacity
Inaction

What staff said when asked about the conversations

"It actually feels like they care."

"Oh, this is different."

"I don't feel so alone."



2

PRINCIPLE

Staff engagement



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The People Committee

A representative group that evaluates and recommends people strategy opportunities



Formed in February 2026.

Meets monthly, with support from Organizational Effectiveness and HR.

How it works.

Ideas are tested against the People Philosophy, screened with Legal, Finance, and the CEO, then recommended to the Senior Leadership Team.

On deck for 2026.

Tuition reimbursement, career development, and employee recognition.

Our People Philosophy

Developed by the Senior Leadership Team, refined by the People Committee, and finalized in 2026.

Introduced to all staff with a short video and now guides every part of our people strategy work.

1

People are at the heart of our mission.

ABP employees, pediatricians, volunteers, and the children we serve are centered in decisions about partnerships, policies, technologies, and strategies.

2

Diversity and belonging make us better.

Diverse backgrounds, ideas, and perspectives strengthen innovation and create a workplace where everyone can thrive.

3

Working openly with trust and respect.

We approach challenges with curiosity, listen with respect, set clear expectations, share context, and speak candidly.

4

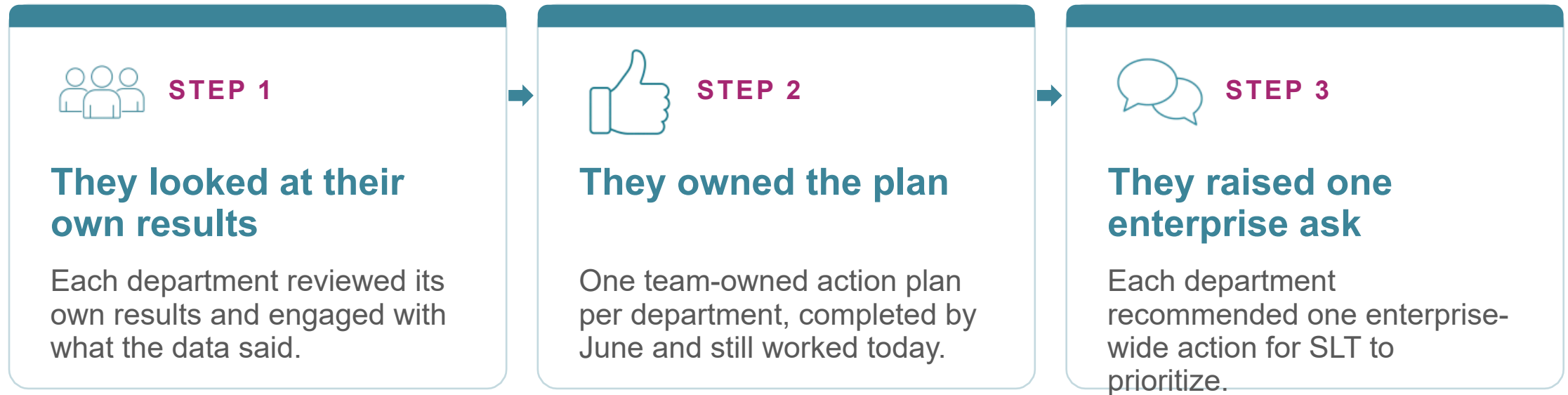
We never stop learning.

We plan for the skills our future requires and invest in development at every stage, so people reach their potential.

5

Building trust through clear and fair decisions.

Clear criteria, fair processes, and equitable access to information, opportunities, and advancement.



“This feels different.”

What staff told us

Where the recommendations converged

Career growth

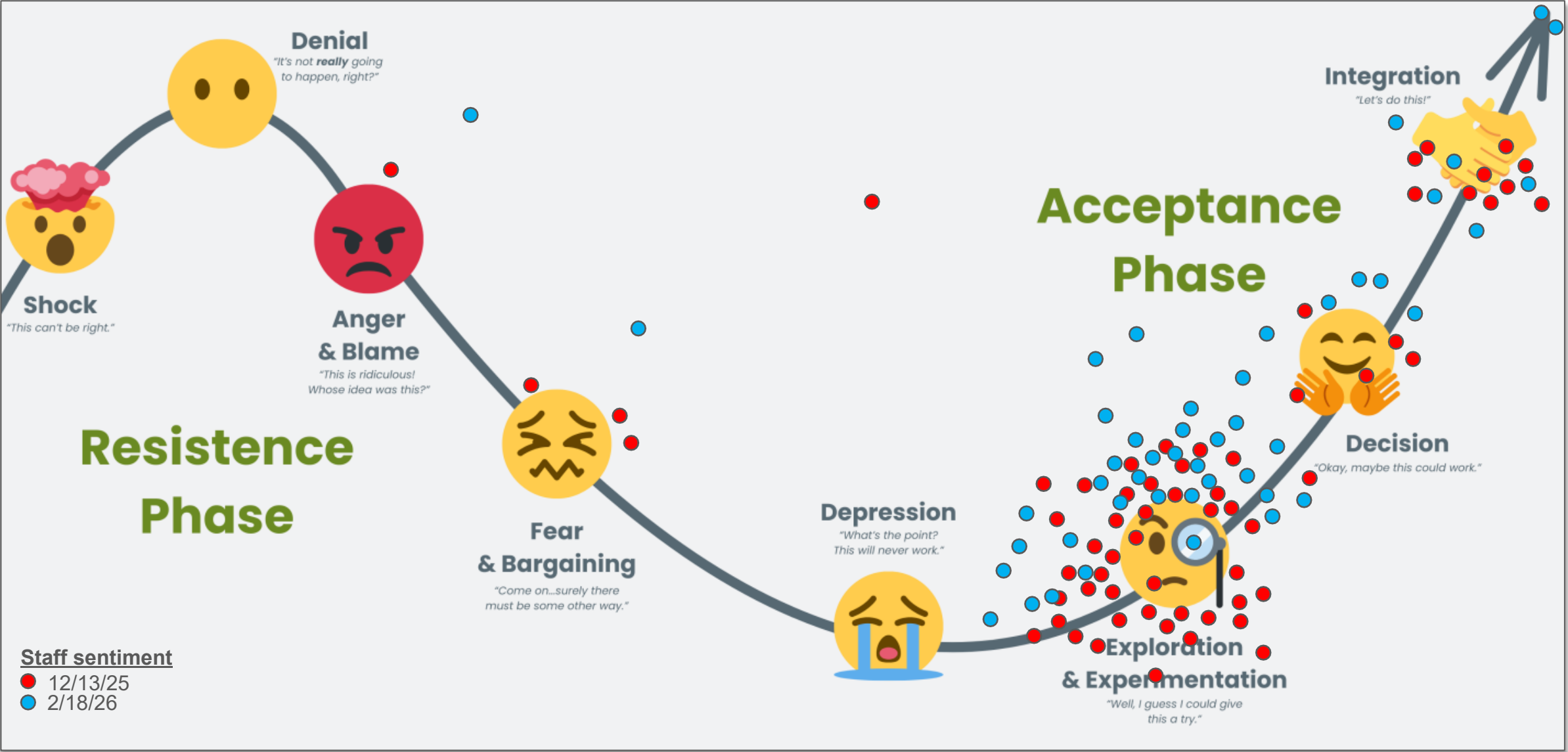
Transparency

Fairness

WHY THIS APPROACH WORKS

- **Ownership, not compliance.** Teams work the plans they built.
- **Signal, not noise.** One ask each made the pattern clear.
- **Momentum people feel.** Input is visibly turning into action.

ABP Change Curve





3

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Do something



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**I'll just save
these sticky
notes for the
next time we do
this workshop.**



4

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Give them the words



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Why.

Feedback here isn't broken — it's uneven. Where it comes late or feels risky, issues linger and expectations stay unclear.

Design.

Clear expectations anchored in the People Philosophy, skill-building workshops, and steady reinforcement. The goal is muscle memory, not a one-time event.

THE WORDS WE GAVE PEOPLE

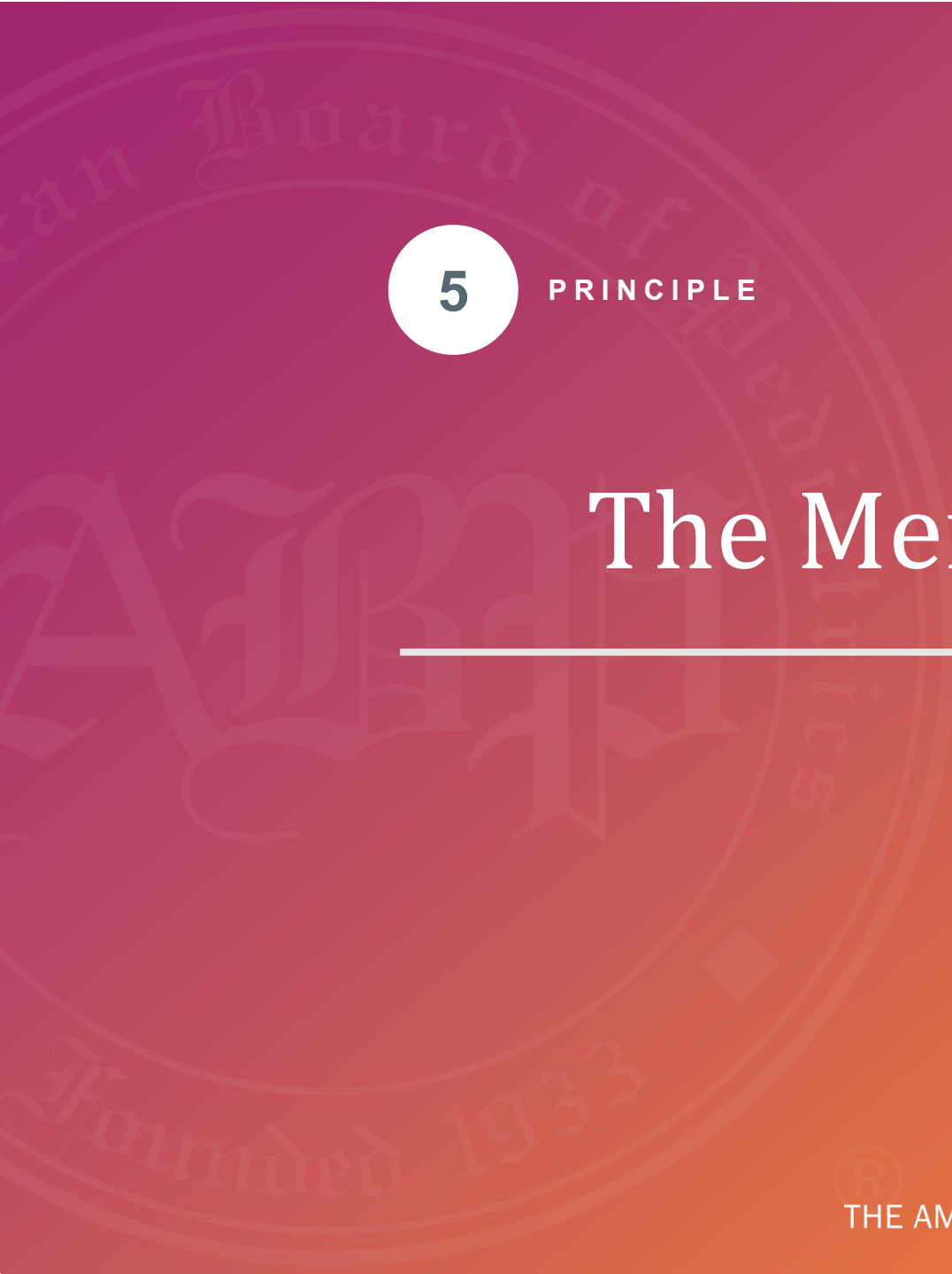
“Okay — say more about that.”

“What’s one thing I could have done differently?”

“Got time for a quick plus/delta?”

“Thought about your feedback — here’s what I acted on, and what I didn’t.”

Same skill, four moments — ask, invite, offer, close the loop.



5

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The Memorable “Why”



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A Day in Dana's Life

Dana balances patients, charting, family, and her life. Maintaining her certification is nowhere near the top of her priority list.





This is a significant change, but it necessary to fulfill our mission—for the ABP, for our diplomates, and for the children they serve.

Meet Dana's colleagues!



Taylor the Trainee

Navigating exam application and certification for the first time. Seeking a seamless user experience

With BTI: Plain language, guided self-service...*and one portal they'll use for the rest of their career!*



Pete the Program Director

Tracking trainees using multiple systems and manual workarounds

With BTI: More automation, user-friendly dashboards, and *streamlined reporting of EPAs!*

Bringing it home



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What I'd take home

1 Make room for the **heart**, not just the head.

2 Ask for **help**, not compliance.

3 **Do something**—then close the loop.

4 Give people the **words**, then let them use them.

5 Make the **why** impossible to forget.

Pick one. Try it. *The world is not going to wait for us.*

It's okay to be human.

“If you catch me there again, just wave this little guy.”

The cave of catastrophe is a normal place to visit—
just don't move in.



What kind of change leader are you?

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Three change styles

Same goal. Different instincts about how change should happen.



The Conservator

builds on what works

“What might we lose?”

continuity and craft



The Pragmatist

gets to a result

“What actually works?”

progress and agreement



The Originator

breaks the mold

“What if we started over?”

possibility and risk

Wants change that...

First question

Energized by

Grounded in change-style research—Kirtan’s Adaption–Innovation theory and the Change Style Indicator. Every organization holds all three.

The Conserver



The Conserver · *Change that respects what we've built*

At their best

The organization's memory. Spots the operational landmine everyone else walked past and protects the quality of what already works.

Under pressure

Digs in. Asks for more data, more process, more time—and can read as resistance when it's really risk management.

What they need from you

The why, early, and specifics. Tell them what is NOT changing—that's often the sentence that unlocks them.

"I'm not against this. I just need to know what happens to the work we already promised."



You're in good company

Warren Buffett · Tim Cook · Atul Gawande

The Pragmatist



The Pragmatist · *Change that gets to a workable result*

At their best

The bridge. Hears both extremes as legitimate, keeps the team moving toward outcomes instead of positions.

Under pressure

Splits the difference too early. Can trade away the bold idea for the version everyone will tolerate.

What they need from you

A clear definition of success and permission to not please everyone. Name the tradeoff you're willing to make.

"I don't care whose idea wins. What can we actually ship by June?"



You're in good company

Bill Gates · Michelle Obama · Dolly Parton

The Originator



The Originator · *Change that breaks the frame*

At their best

The one who says the unsayable. Generates the option nobody had on the list and raises everyone's ambition.

Under pressure

Reopens settled decisions and moves on before the last idea landed. Can exhaust the people implementing.

What they need from you

A real outlet for ideas and an honest no. Tell them when the door is closed—and why—or they'll keep knocking.

"Why are we optimizing a process we shouldn't be doing at all?"



You're in good company

Jane Goodall · Oprah Winfrey · Steve Jobs

When they cross paths



Originator meets Conserver

“You’re reckless.” · “You’re an obstacle.”

The loudest collision in any change effort—and both of them are protecting the mission.



Pragmatist meets Originator

“You’re impractical.” · “You’re watering it down.”

The big idea meets the delivery date. Someone has to say what we’re actually building.



Conserver meets Pragmatist

“You’re cutting corners.” · “You’re slowing us down.”

Both want it to work. They disagree on how much certainty is enough to move.

Name the style out loud and the heat drops. *You stop arguing about character and start discussing the work.*

Try it with a partner

Find a partner — ideally someone whose instincts run differently than yours. Ten minutes.

- Name the style you think you are, and how it shows up at work.
- Tell a story about a time that style got in your way.
- Name one thing this framework helps you do differently next time.

Where did you recognize yourself — or someone you work with?

Breakout Session Rooms

- **Breakouts: 3:15 – 4:15**

- Shaping the Future of Residency Education: Opportunities to Redefine Assessment and Competency Evaluation (Room – Pollock)
- AI Literacy at Board Staff Level (Room – Cassatt AB)
- Small Boards: Working Our Way - Navigating Challenges and Celebrating Successes (Room – Warhol)

- **Breakouts: 4:30 – 5:30**

- Don't Digitize Yesterday, Design for Tomorrow (Room – Cassatt AB)
- The Importance of Psychological Safety for Today's Member Board Community Workforce (Room – Pollock)
- Communications Catch-Up (Room – Warhol)

ABMS MEMBER BOARDS *Connect*

MEMBER BOARDS CONNECT 2026

Agenda at a glance

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